What's true of politics, ethics, and economics is also true of aesthetics. In medieval Europe art was governed by objective yardsticks. The standards of beauty were not supposed to reflect human feelings. Rather, human tastes were required to conform to allegedly superhuman dictates. People believed that the hands of painters, poets, composers, and architects were moved by muses, angels, and the Holy Spirit.

Liberalism has completely rejected these views, and believes instead that the only source for artistic creation and aesthetic value is human feelings. Modern artists seek to get in touch with themselves and their feelings, rather than with gods and muses. When liberals come to evaluate art, they do not rely on any objective yardsticks. Instead, they again turn to our subjective feelings. Just as in politics liberalism instructs us that "the voter knows best," and in economics "the customer is always right," so in aesthetics the liberal principle is that "beauty is in the eye of the beholder."

In 1917 Marcel Duchamp took an ordinary mass-produced urinal, named it *Fountain*, signed it, declared it a work of art and placed it in a museum. This is considered a crucial milestone in the history of art. In countless classrooms across the world, first-year art students are shown an image of Duchamp's *Fountain*, and at a sign from the teacher, all hell breaks loose. "It is art!" "No it isn't!" "Yes it is!" "No way!" After letting the students release some steam, the teacher focuses the discussion by asking "What do *you* think art is? And how do we determine whether something is a work of art or not?" After a few more minutes of back-and-forth, the teacher steers the class in the right direction: "Art is anything people think is art, and beauty is in the eye of the beholder." If people feel that a urinal is a beautiful work of art – then it is. What higher authority is there that can tell us that our feelings are wrong?

Finally, the rise of liberalism has revolutionised the educational system, too. In medieval Europe the source of all meaning and authority was external, hence education focused on instilling obedience, memorising scriptures, and studying ancient traditions. Teachers presented students with questions, but didn't ask the students for their personal opinions. Rather, students had to remember the answers given by the Bible, Aristotle or Thomas Aquinas.

In contrast, modern liberal education believes in teaching students to think for themselves. It is good to know what the Bible, Aristotle and Thomas Aquinas thought about art, politics and economics; yet since the